

its own distinctive way, in particular integrating influences from non-European musical traditions. His exquisite sequence of small-scale music dramas written between 1964 and 1969 (Curlew River, The Burning Fiery Furnace, and The Prodigal Son) drew inspiration from Japanese Noh theater and Balinese gamelan, among other sources. His opera Owen Wingrave, commissioned for television and broadcast in 1971, was far less successful, failing perhaps because of his lack of sympathy for the medium (he never owned a television set).



OPERA BY THE SEA

Cast members take to the stage during the first performance of “Grimes on the Beach,” a production of Britten’s opera Peter Grimes at the Aldeburgh Festival on June 17, 2013.

Final years

From 1957 to the end of his life, Britten lived with Pears at the Red House in Aldeburgh, on the same bleak Suffolk coast where